Document Upload — Discovery Kickoff Prep

Meeting type: Discovery (understand the problem before writing requirements)

Pre-read: Sections 1 and 2 below. Please read before the session.

Facilitator note: Items marked [Open] are unknowns we resolve in the room — they are the agenda.

---

1. First-cut Requirements Contract

Problem Statement

[Open] — "The business wants document upload" is a solution, not a problem. The real problem is unstated. Candidates to confirm: users currently email documents / hand them over manually / can't attach evidence to a request, and that's slow, unauditable, or error-prone.

Desired Outcome

[Open] — What is true after we ship that isn't true today? (e.g. "a customer can attach supporting documents to their request without emailing us.")

Business Value (why now?)

Lever	Hypothesis to confirm
Cost reduction	Less manual handling / re-keying [Open]
Risk reduction	Auditable trail, fewer lost documents, compliance [Open]
Customer experience	Self-service instead of email back-and-forth [Open]
Revenue	[Open — probably not the driver, confirm]

Scope (draft — confirm each line)

In scope (proposed): upload one/many files, tie a document to a record (a request/case/user?), store it, let someone retrieve it.

Out of scope (propose to defer): editing document contents, e-signing, OCR/data extraction, versioning, approval workflow on the document itself — unless the business says otherwise.

Assumptions to validate

- Uploaders are [Open — external customers? internal staff? both?].
- Documents attach to an existing entity [Open — what entity?].
- This is web/browser-based [Open — mobile too?].
- We store files ourselves [Open — or a system of record already exists?].

Success Metrics (need real targets)

Metric	Target
Adoption / % submitted via upload vs. old channel	[Open]

Metric	Target
Time from upload to available/processed	[Open]
Failed-upload rate	[Open]

---

2. Open Questions — the backbone of the meeting

Who & what

1. Who uploads — external customers, internal staff, or both?
2. What does a document attach to — a request, a case, a user profile, a transaction?
3. Who needs to read the document afterward, and from where?

The document itself

4. Which file types are allowed? (PDF only? images? Office docs?)
5. Max file size, and how many files per upload / per record?
6. Any content we must reject or flag (e.g. wrong document type)?

Rules & lifecycle

7. Is upload mandatory or optional for the surrounding process?
8. Can a user replace or delete after uploading? Version history needed?
9. How long must documents be retained, and when/if are they deleted?

Security, privacy, compliance (often the real cost driver)

10. Do these documents contain personal / sensitive / regulated data (PII, health, financial, ID docs)?
11. Malware scanning required before anyone can open a file?
12. Who is allowed to see a given document — access control rules?
13. Any regulatory regime in play (GDPR, KYC/AML, HIPAA-equivalent, industry rules)?
14. Is an audit trail (who uploaded/viewed/deleted, when) required?

Systems & constraints

15. Where do files physically live — new storage, or an existing DMS/CRM/record system?
16. Any existing upload capability we're replacing or extending?
17. Deadline / budget / team constraints already fixed?

Failure & edge cases

18. What happens on a failed / interrupted upload?
19. Notifications — does anyone get told a document arrived?
20. Volume expectations — uploads per day/peak?

---

3. Stakeholder Map

Stakeholder	Why they're essential	Interest	Influence	If absent, you risk…
Business sponsor	Owns the "why now" and the budget	High	High	Building the wrong thing
Product owner / BA	Owns scope & priorities	High	High	Scope drift
End users (customers or uploading staff)	Ground truth on the current pain	High	Med	A feature nobody adopts
Ops / support team	Handle the documents today	High	Med	Missing real-world edge cases
Security / Compliance / DPO	File uploads = attack surface + data protection	High	High	Late, expensive rework or a legal blocker
Engineering / Tech lead	Feasibility, storage, integration	Med	Med	Unbuildable commitments
Records / retention owner	Retention & deletion rules	Med	Med	Regulatory non-compliance

Don't skip Security/Compliance at the kickoff. For upload features they are the difference between a two-week and a two-month build. Get them in the room now, not at sign-off.

---

4. Workshop Plan (90 min)

Objective: Understand the underlying problem, agree scope boundaries, and surface the security/compliance and data constraints — enough to draft high-level requirements.

Pre-read (send with invite): Sections 1 and 2 of this document.

Time	Segment	Goal
0–10	Frame the problem — sponsor states the "why now"	Align on problem, not solution
10–25	Walk the current process ("show me how a document reaches you today")	Ground truth
25–45	Scope: what's in / out / later (Q1–9)	Draw the boundary
45–65	Security, privacy, compliance, retention (Q10–14, 15)	Surface the real constraints early
65–80	Systems, volumes, failure cases (Q15–20)	Feasibility & edges
80–90	Recap, decisions, assumptions, owners, next steps	Close with accountability

---

5. Risks to raise in the room

Risk	Why it matters here
Uploaded malware reaches internal users	Any upload feature; needs scanning before access
Sensitive/PII documents without proper access control & retention	Legal + reputational; drives the whole design
"Just upload" hides a real workflow (review/approval)	Scope balloons after kickoff if not named now
No system of record decided → storage/integration rework	Architectural, expensive to change late
Ambiguous file-type/size rules → rework	Cheap to pin down now

---

6. Seed Glossary (fill live)

Term	Working definition	Status
Document	A file a user uploads and attaches to a record	Needs SME confirmation
Upload	The act of transferring a file into the system	Needs SME confirmation
Record / entity	The thing a document attaches to (request? case? profile?)	Conflicting — resolve first
Retention	How long a document is kept before deletion	Needs SME confirmation

---

7. Expected outputs of the session

- Confirmed problem statement and business driver
- Agreed in/out-of-scope list
- Answers (or named owners) for the 20 open questions
- Logged assumptions, risks, and decisions with owners
- Green light to draft high-level requirements

Next step: capture the notes, then draft high-level requirements and testable acceptance criteria. A human (RE/PO + sponsor + compliance) owns the final scope call.